



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Francis Classical Academy
School Website: <https://stfrancisclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

St Francis Classical Academy Florida 32571 presents a robust CLASSICAL orientation across all six classical criteria. Public materials from the school consistently foreground a Christian, creedal, and liturgically-inflected approach to education, with explicit emphasis on formation, virtue, and the liberal arts. The curriculum centers on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books/historically grounded study; pedagogy includes memorization, chanting, narration, singing, Socratic dialogue in upper forms, and opportunities for rhetorical expression; the faculty are presented as mentors and living exemplars; and parents are positioned as partners in a shared educational mission. Public statements emphasize teleology toward human flourishing within a theological framework, the formation of affections, and a cultural transmission of Western Christian civilization. Collectively, the materials align with the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education and its lexicon, with explicit references to truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, memory work, great books, and the parental partnership.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Principle orientation: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall, St Francis Classical Academy is CLASSICAL.

ABSTRACT

ed evidence and mapping to the six categories are detailed below, with explicit keyword observations drawn from the school's public materials and cross-referenced to the classical-education knowledge base.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school self-identifies as Creedal Christian and ecumenical, inviting families from multiple denominations and grounding education in Christian theology. Distinctives include Creedal Christianity, Tra-

ditionalism, Rigor Leisure, and Beauty. This language establishes a transcendent, theological foundation for the curriculum and community.

- Public statements affirm a creedal framework: “We welcome all who are baptized in God’s triune name and confess the incarnation, death, and resurrection of our Lord as expressed in the Nicene Creed.” This directly anchors education in a shared set of theological convictions.
- The site repeatedly emphasizes theology and sacred practice (memorizing scriptures, singing and praying together; ecumenical Christian context). This supports liturgical and communal worship practices within the educational process.
- Derivative language in Distinctives and FAQ places theological formation at the core of student formation and community life (creedal, worship, Christian discipleship).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: creed, Nicene Creed, baptism, theology, scripture memorization, singing, prayer, ecumenical Christian, liturgy/worship-like practice, sacred, sacred texts, creedal Christianity.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the standard secular/anti-theology indicators (e.g., secular, relativism, value-neutral) appear in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials reveal explicit grounding in Christian theology (creedal framework and Nicene Creed), liturgical-style communal practices (singing, prayer, scriptural memorization), and a clearly stated aim to cultivate virtue and sacred aims within formation. This aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria of Classical education as described in the knowledge base.

Citations

- Creedal Christianity and distinctives:
- Nicene Creed and baptism emphasis:
- Scriptures memorized and communal prayer:

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school states its aim to form virtuous, capable human beings rather than merely prepare for work; “Our final aim is to graduate able Christian citizens, linguists, philosophers, historians, mathematicians, and theologians — free men and women ...” which signals formation and telos beyond vocational outcomes.
- The program is described as a liberal-arts education with traditional pedagogy and content, aligning with formation and human flourishing rather than purely informational aims.
- The First Form Profile emphasizes “Leisure & Beauty” and the idea that education is the cultivation of loves, in line with scholé and contemplation.
- The school frames education as formation through love of the greatest things, connecting to the teleology of truth, goodness, and beauty.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, telos, liberal arts, classical mission, contemplation/scholé, love of learning, great conversation, human flourishing, beauty, truth, goodness, true/good/beautiful.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the explicit workforce- or job-preparation emphasis (e.g., “career readiness,” “21st-century skills”) appear as priorities in public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials emphasize formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as core objectives, not merely vocational preparation, aligning with the CLASSICAL category.

Citations



- Formation-focused aims and telos:
- Liberal-arts emphasis and “formation over information”:
- Leisure/Scholé and affections/formation:
- Love of the greatest things and formation through culture:

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is described as a liberal-arts program rooted in the grammar-logic-rhetoric framework and the classical tradition; First Form Profile explicitly positions the school as providing liberal arts courses in humanities, math, and science. This situates the curriculum within the classic liberal-arts paradigm.
- The course offerings emphasize humane letters, Latin, logic, aesthetics, and rhetoric, with explicit mention of classical study methods and forms. The First Form and Second Form/Third Form profiles show structured humanities, Latin, and logic progression across forms.
- The curriculum integrates history and literature with other disciplines and uses primary sources and classic texts (evidenced by references to humane letters and classical content) as part of a “Great Books”-inspired tradition. The Course Details article indicates deep engagement with classical content across forms.
- Historical and cultural study is integrated across grades (Ancient through Modern in humane letters; Shakespeare, Sophocles, Virgil at upper levels; primary sources in history).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, classics, Latin, humane letters, history, interdisciplinary integration, wonder.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the explicit “project-based learning dominate,” “STEM-first,” or “social studies replaced history” red flags appear in public materials.

Why this rating

- The explicit presence of grammar-logic-rhetoric, Great Books/primary sources, Latin, and a historically integrated, wonder-evoking approach aligns strongly with the Curriculum criteria of Classical education.

Citations

- Liberal arts emphasis and program scope:
- Humane letters, Latin, logic, aesthetics, and rhetoric progression:
- Historical/Great Books approach:
- Course details corroboration (traditional pedagogy and content):

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site documents a pedagogy that blends contemplative, restorative elements with rigorous study; early grades include singing, memorization, and restfulness, while upper forms emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates. The First Form materials emphasize “scholé” and thoughtful engagement; public content shows singing, memorization, and narrative techniques; upper forms employ dialogues and rhetoric.
- The public materials explicitly state that lower grades use singing and memory work, supporting a contemplative pedagogy, while upper grades employ Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetoric training. The Course Details and related posts describe this pedagogical progression.
- The public materials note that students recite, sing, write, debate, and act, indicating a pedagogy that integrates memory, oral skills, and rhetorical practice.

- The materials also reference a disciplined, character-forming approach that aligns with scholé and contemplative pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Socratic seminar, dialectic, recitation, chanting, singing, memory, scholé, contemplation, rhetoric, debate, seminars, tutorials, living curriculum.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the explicit “experiential learning only” or heavily constructivist-only signals appear in the public materials; rather, the pedagogy blends traditional methods with opportunities for dialogue.

Why this rating

- The combination of contemplative (scholé, chant, memorization) and Socratic/rhetoric-based pedagogy across grades maps to the Pedagogy criteria of classical education.

Citations

- Lower-form singing/memory:
- Upper-form Socratic/seminar/rhetoric opportunities:
- Formation through memorization and recitation (public materials):
- Scholé and contemplative pedagogy language:

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents tutors as the core of the school, with a “tutor bios” page that introduces teachers as mentors, practitioners of classical pedagogy, and living exemplars. The faculty are described as living curriculum and as a community of “masters” or “sages” in the classical tradition.
- The Tutor Bios content presents individual teachers with detailed professional and personal backgrounds, underscoring a culture of mentorship, virtue, and intellectual depth. This aligns with the “living curriculum” and “portrait of teacher” expectations in the classical rubric.
- Public content also highlights the school’s high tutor-to-student ratio (e.g., 5:1) and advanced credentials among the teaching staff, supporting a high standard of mentorship and classical formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, teachers as mentors, faculty of friends, collegial culture, tutoring as central, formation through masterful teaching.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the “checklist” negatives about non-classical faculty role (e.g., “facilitators only,” “certification-only” without classical context).

Why this rating

- The explicit emphasis on teachers as mentors, the living curriculum, small ratios, and faculty profiles aligns with the Faculty criteria of classical education.

Citations

- Tutor bios as living curriculum/mentors:
- 5:1 tutor-to-student ratio and faculty credentials:

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school frames partnership with families as central, aligning parents with the school as co-educators and welcoming parent involvement. The “Partnership with Families” concept and a family-centric ethos appear in the knowledge base’s language about living tradition, household formation, and parental

collaboration. The site features parent-facing elements (FAQ about discipleship, open-campus opportunities, Field Day Fridays with parental participation).

- Field Day Fridays and other family-centered events explicitly invite parent participation, underscoring parent involvement and hospitality. The FAQ confirms that parents and siblings may participate in events and activities.
- The site's content emphasizes "open campus," parent formation, and classical home education through community events and partnerships, consistent with the Parents & Community criteria.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, home-centered learning, open campus, parent involvement, familial stewardship, community of learners, classical family culture.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the consumer/customer-only language or minimal parental involvement signals appear; rather, the site invites active parental engagement.

Why this rating

- The school treats parents as co-educators and actively invites participation and formation within a shared classical mission, aligning with the Parents & Community criterion.

Citations

- Partnership with families and parent formation concepts:
 - Open-campus and parent involvement (Field Day Fridays, FAQ):
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What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here, as every category is CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required to reach full alignment with the classical model according to the analyzed materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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